

At times when you really want to try out new software but can't do so for some reason – you already have a licensed older version working correctly or because you fear that installing too much at a time will slow down your system pathetically in the long run or because when the installer of the new version detects that you have an older version – it doesn't leave you with a choice except an upgrade. This is when virtual machines come to the rescue.

You can simply install a virtual machine and install your desired OS and software inside it. Try it, look for the features and if you're satisfied, you can install it. It's especially useful if the software you're trying to test out is a paid one. Virtual machines can help decide whether you really want it or not. Oh, and a virtual machine would have no problem if you tried and tested free software either!

Keeping yourself secure – virus checks and secure browsing

There are times when you want to check for viruses using multiple anti-virus tools. While some people are fond of installing more than one anti-virus with the rationale that “having two tablets for the headache is better than having one” without understanding the repercussions, at times you might just find yourself in need of using more than one anti-virus packages for scanning a file. Want an example? Here's one: let's say you downloaded new software from the internet and just before you install it, you see a review saying “Norton Anti-virus said it has a virus”. But let's suppose you're using Avast which doesn't warn you about any such virus. That's FUD (Fear Uncertainty and Doubt)! That's one scenario when you'd want to have more than one anti-virus tool at hand. Now, there's a possibility that you might think you could simply install both anti-virus tools for once, scan the file in both and then remove the one which isn't needed. If you're one of those who agree with such ways of thinking, you may be surprised to know that two anti-virus products installed together are one of those perfect ways to slow down your system in the long term. Even if it's done for temporary use. This happens because during installations, installation programs usually don't clear some files from the disk and the registry keys they were created!

In addition, if you take the example above where we mentioned Avast, you might not be able to use both of them. When Avast detects that another anti-virus product is installed on your system, it will switch off all its components which might create a conflict with the other one. We're calling this a great feature because it ensures that if the user doesn't know about the